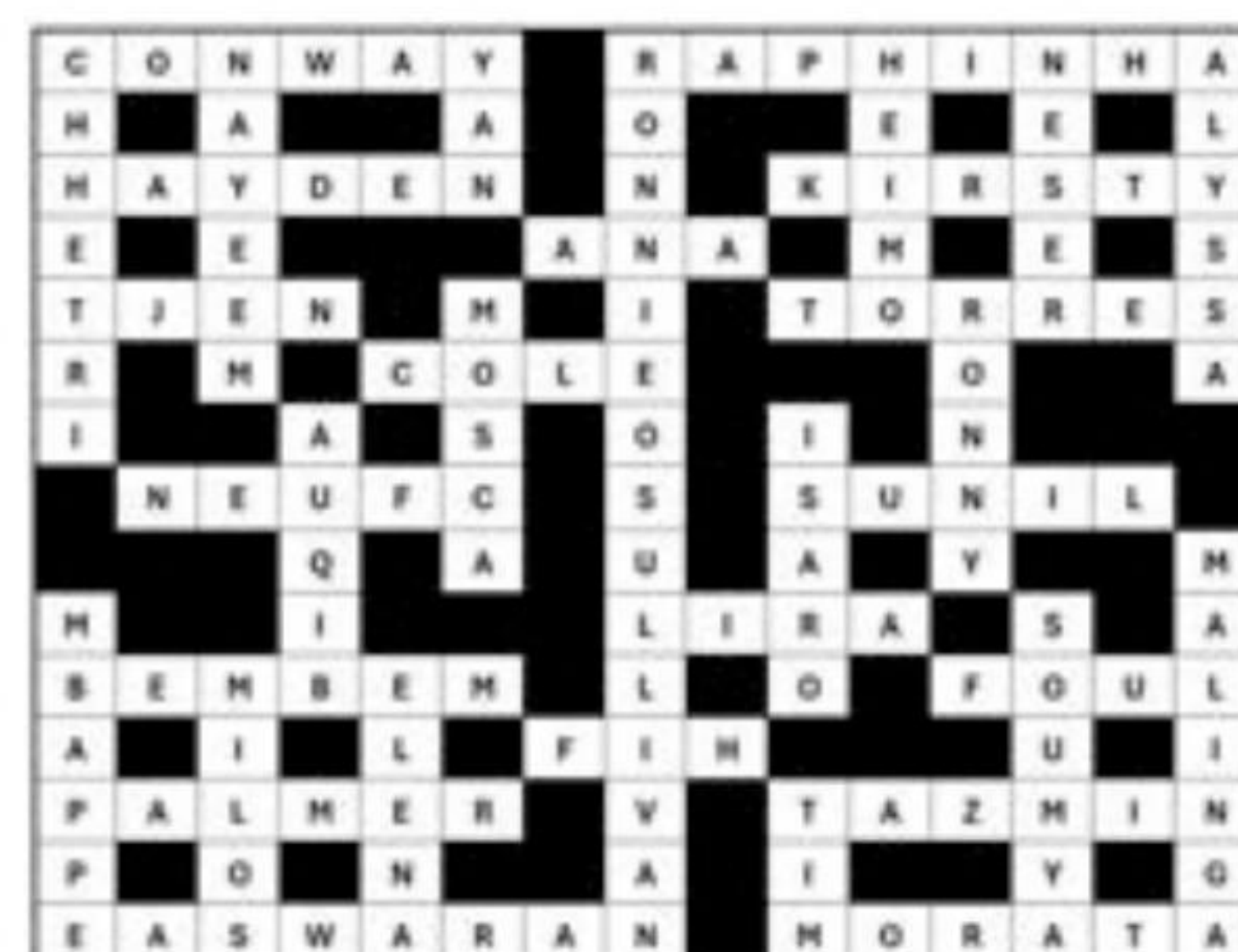
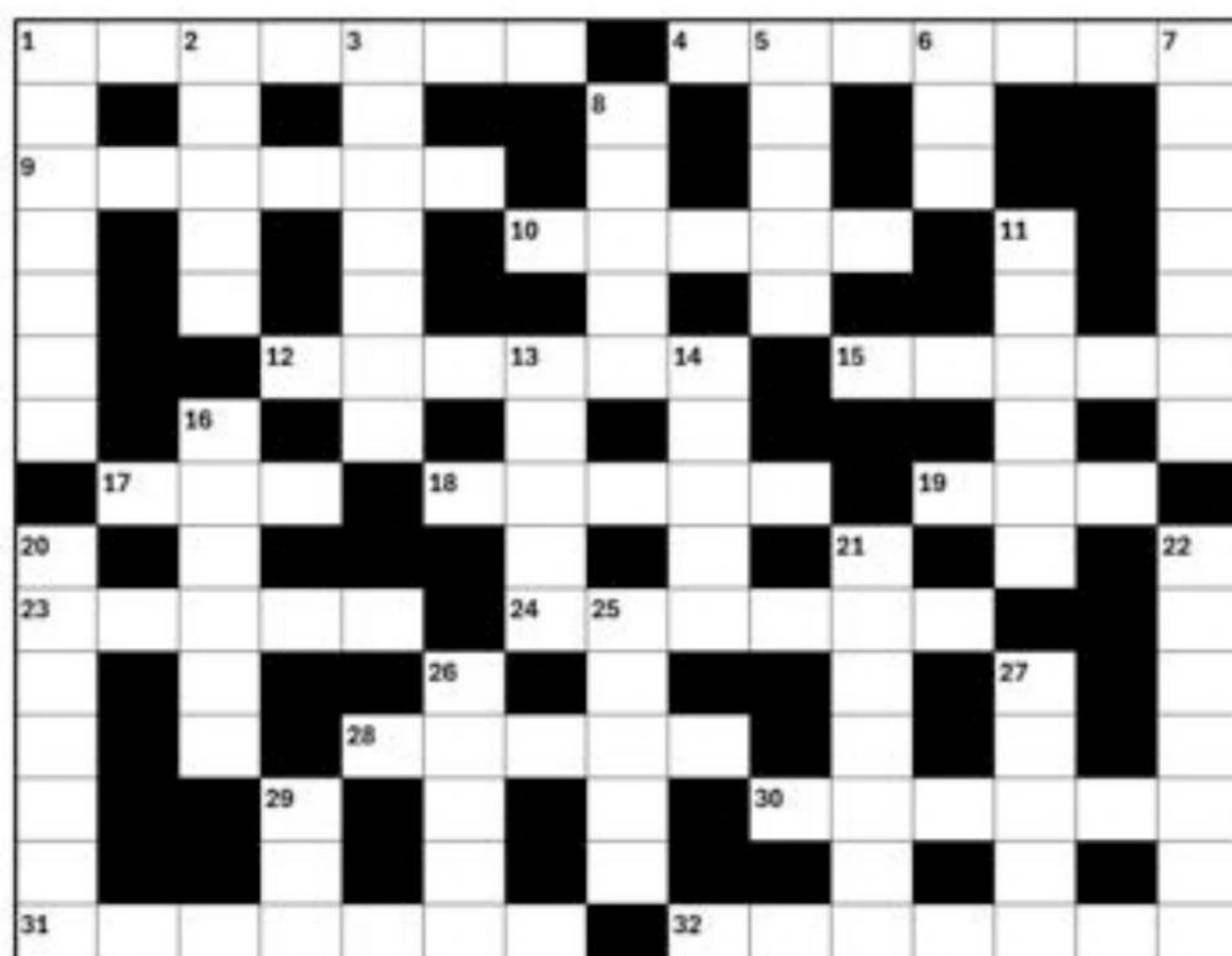


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 1** Who scored a hat-trick for Lyon in the Ligue 1 match versus Metz on January 25, 2026? (7)
- 4 & 10** Who became the 95th chess Grandmaster of India? (7,5)
- 9** Identify the surname of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for Real Madrid in the La Liga encounter against Real Betis on January 4, 2026. (6)
- 12 & 17** Who coached Nepal during the recent T20 World Cup? (6,3)
- 15** Identify the surname of this bowler who became the first to take three wickets in his very first over on IPL debut. (5)
- 18** Identify the surname of this tennis player who was the first-ever American to win the Wimbledon Championships. (5)
- 19** Identify the surname of this cricketer who was the Player of the Series in the Syed Mushtaq Ali tournament of the 2025-26 season. (3)
- 23** Identify the surname of the oldest Olympic champion who passed away aged 101 in October 2025. (5)
- 24** Identify the surname of the UAE coach in the recent T20 World Cup. (6)
- 28** Which city's team won the Pro-Kabaddi League in 2025? (5)
- 30** Identify the first name of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for Barcelona in the UEFA Champions League match against Olympiacos on October 21, 2025. (6)
- 31** Identify the surname of this Australian off-spinner who opened the bowling in England's second innings of the

sixth Test at the SCG in February 1979. (7)

- 32** Identify the surname of this Spanish businessman and politician who was re-elected as the President of FC Barcelona in March 2026. (7)

DOWN

- 1** Which country won the women's hockey World Cup qualifier held in Hyderabad in March 2026? (7)
- 2** Identify the first name of this cricketer who won the Player of the Series award in the ODI series held recently between India and New Zealand. (5)
- 3** Identify the surname of this footballer who scored the winning goal of the 2010 World Cup final. (7)
- 5** Identify the surname of this footballer who won the Golden Boot in the 1982 World Cup. (5)
- 6** Identify the first name of this cricketer who not only won the Player of the Series award but also scored the most runs of WPL 2026. (3)
- 7** Identify the surname of this former cricketer who was named as the new head coach of the Sri Lankan men's national cricket team. (7)
- 8** Which State team won the Ranji Trophy Plate Championship of 2025-26 season to qualify for the Elite League for next season? (5)
- 11** Identify the first name of the South African cricketer who won the Player of the Series award in the recently held T20I series against New Zealand. (6)
- 13** Identify the surname of this hockey player who was the top goal-scorer of

the men's Asia Cup held in Rajgir in 2025. (5)

- 14** Identify the first name of this legendary cyclist who won the Tour de France in 2025. (5)
- 16** Identify the surname of this sportsperson who had played international hockey for South Africa including the Hockey World Cup, later took part as captain of the Italy team in the first match of the T20 World Cup in 2026? (6)
- 20** Identify the surname of this golfer who won the prestigious Augusta Master's title held in April 2026. (7)
- 21** Identify the first name of the player who became the first left-arm wrist spinner to represent India in international cricket. (7)
- 22** Who scored a hat-trick for PSG in the UEFA Champions League match against the Spurs on November 26, 2025? (7)
- 25** Identify the first name of this Indian sportsperson who won the JSW Indian Open squash championship held in March 2026. (5)
- 26** Identify the surname of this father and son pair from the Netherlands who played against India in regular 50-over cricket World Cup/ (5)
- 27** Identify the first name of this Pakistani who won the silver medal in the squash men's singles event at the Asian Games held in Guangzhou in 2010. (5)
- 29** In IPL auction, what do the owners do for picking a player for their team? (3)